

Word family: **superpower / superpowers / superpowered**

Base word: superpower

Plural: superpowers

Related form: superpowered

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-related form (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “In a world where everyone seems to want instant results, patience feels almost like a **superpower**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **superpower** is figurative. It means an **exceptionally useful or impressive ability that gives someone an unusual advantage**.

Patience is not literally a magical power. The speaker means that patience has become so rare and valuable that it can feel almost extraordinary.

繁體中文： **極其有用、罕見或強大的能力，令人好像擁有超乎一般人的優勢；比喻「超能力」**

中文翻譯：

> “...patience feels almost like a **superpower**.”

「.....耐性幾乎就像一種**超能力 / 非常強大的特殊優勢**。」

Here:

patience is a superpower = 耐性非常有價值，強大得像一種特殊能力

1. **superpower = extraordinary fictional ability (虛構能力) — 超能力**

This is the central popular-culture meaning.

Meaning: An extraordinary ability beyond normal human abilities, especially one possessed by a superhero or fictional character.

Practice 1

> “The character’s **superpower** is the ability to become invisible.”

「這個角色的**超能力**是可以隱形。」

Practice 2

> “If you could choose one **superpower**, what would it be?”

「如果你可以選擇一種**超能力**，你會選甚麼？」

****superpower = 普通人不具備、超越正常人體能力的特殊力量或能力****

Common examples conceptually include:

- * flying
- * invisibility
- * extraordinary strength
- * mind-reading

The exact power changes, but the semantic concept stays the same.

2. ****superpower = exceptionally strong personal ability (比喻) — 超強能力；特殊優勢****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** A skill, quality, or personal strength that is unusually powerful or useful.

Practice 3 — Original

> “Patience feels almost like a **superpower**.”

「耐性幾乎就像一種**超能力 / 極強的個人優勢**。」

Practice 4

> “Her ability to stay calm under pressure is her **superpower**.”

「她在壓力下保持冷靜的能力就是她的**超強優勢 / 超能力**。」

Practice 5

> “Listening carefully can be a real **superpower**.”

「仔細聆聽可以是一種真正非常強大的**能力 / 優勢**。」

****superpower = 比喻某種特別強、特別有價值，能讓人明顯受益的能力或特質****

This is figurative, but very common in modern motivational, workplace, educational, and conversational English.

3. **superpower** = extremely powerful country (國際關係) — 超級大國

Superpower also has an established geopolitical meaning: a country with exceptionally great international power and influence, particularly political and military power. Cambridge also gives the Traditional Chinese translation **超級大國**. ([劍橋詞典][1])

Practice 6

> “The history course examined relations between major **superpowers**.”

「歷史課程研究了主要**超級大國**之間的關係。」

Practice 7

> “The term **superpower** is often used in discussions of international relations.”

「**超級大國**這個詞常見於國際關係的討論中。」

superpower = 在世界政治、軍事及國際影響力方面擁有極大力量的國家 ([劍橋詞典][1])

This is genuinely different from a superhero's ability.

Related form: **superpowered**

Superpowered usually means possessing superpowers or having unusually great power.

superpowered = having fictional superpowers (擁有超能力的)

Practice 8

> “The film follows a group of **superpowered** teenagers.”

「這部電影講述一群擁有**超能力的**青少年。」

Practice 9

> “The game features several **superpowered** characters.”

「這款遊戲有幾個**擁有超能力的**角色。」

****superpowered = 擁有超乎常人能力的****

**superpowered = unusually powerful (比喻) — 超強的**

It can also be used figuratively for something unusually powerful or capable.

Practice 10

> “The software feels like a ****superpowered**** version of the basic tool.”

「這款軟件就像基本工具的****超強版****。」

****superpowered = 功能或能力遠超一般水平的；非正式****

Important distinction: **superpower vs power**

**power**

is extremely broad and can mean:

- * ability
- * control
- * strength
- * energy
- * authority

**superpower**

means either:

- * an extraordinary fictional ability;
- * an unusually strong figurative ability;
- * a geopolitically very powerful country.

So:

> “Patience is a power.”

sounds unusual.

> “Patience is a superpower.”

works as a playful, emphatic metaphor.

Important distinction: **superpower vs talent**

talent

means a natural or developed ability at something.

superpower

figuratively means a talent or quality that seems **exceptionally powerful or advantageous**.

> “She has a talent for explaining things.”

neutral.

> “Explaining complicated ideas simply is her superpower.”

more emphatic and figurative.

Important distinction: **superpower vs strength**

strength

is the neutral general word for a positive ability or quality.

superpower

adds exaggeration and vivid imagery.

> “Patience is one of his strengths.”

= 耐性是他的優點之一。

> “Patience is his superpower.”

= 耐性強得像是他的超能力。

The second is much more expressive.

Important distinction: **superpower** vs **special ability**

special ability

is literal and neutral.

superpower

usually evokes superhero imagery, even when used metaphorically.

That is why your sentence works so well:

- > patience is ordinary in one sense
- > but its value is described as extraordinary.

Countability note

Superpower is countable in all its main meanings:

- > a superpower
- > several superpowers

Examples:

- > “Flying would be a useful superpower.”
- > “Several superpowers shaped the international system.”

So the plural form is straightforward:

superpowers

Family-extension note

The practical modern family is small:

- * **superpower**
- * **superpowers**
- * **superpowered**

Most of the learning value lies in the contrast between three concepts:

- * fictional extraordinary ability
- * figurative exceptional personal strength
- * extremely powerful country

The Golden Manual says that where a word family is genuinely small, we should not artificially expand it, but we should still include established figurative and domain-specific senses.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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superpower — fictional ability	超越普通人能力的特殊力量或能力；超能力
superpower — figurative personal strength	特別強大、罕見或有價值，能給某人明顯優勢的能力或特質
superpower — country	在世界政治、軍事及國際影響力方面擁有極大力量的國家；超級大國 ([劍橋詞典][1])
superpowered	擁有超能力的；亦可非正式地指功能或力量異常強大的

For your original sentence

> “...patience feels almost like a **superpower**.”

The exact meaning is:

****superpower = 一種強大得近乎超乎一般人的特殊能力或優勢****

So:

> ****patience feels like a superpower****

= ****耐性強大而有價值得像一種超能力****

The sentence deliberately borrows the superhero meaning and applies it figuratively:

- > fictional superpower → extraordinary ability
- > patience → unusually valuable real-life ability

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely distinct core meanings**** for ****superpower****:

1. ****an extraordinary fictional ability****
2. ****figuratively, an exceptionally powerful personal ability or quality****
3. ****a country with exceptionally great global power and influence****

I would keep ****superpowered**** as a family extension and avoid splitting different fictional abilities or different kinds of national power into separate senses.

[1]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/superpower?utm_source=chatgpt.com
"SUPERPOWER | definition in the Cambridge English Dictionary"